

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure and Microsoft 365 Security, Security Architecture and Automation

United Kingdom (Remote/Hybrid) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience designing, implementing, reviewing and managing security measures across Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments. I bring strong hands-on capability in developing and assessing security architecture artefacts, implementing security controls and standards across cloud and hybrid infrastructure, and identifying and delivering automation across provisioning, policy enforcement and security operations workflows. I am experienced in applying security frameworks including the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework, Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls and ISO 27001 to real-world deployments, and I use PowerShell and scripting tooling extensively to automate repetitive security engineering tasks. My background combines the precision of a hands-on security engineer with the communication skills to engage senior stakeholders and advise on security architecture decisions at both technical and strategic levels.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, Entra Connect, Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Azure security configuration and M365 Defender suite
- **Security Architecture:** Designing, developing, maintaining and assessing security architecture artefacts; implementing security engineering best practices and standards across cloud and hybrid environments
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell - Strong; SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) playbook development; automation of cloud provisioning, policy enforcement and security operations workflows
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender - Strong; CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) - Expert
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Threat Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); detection rule development, analytics tuning and threat hunting
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); least-privilege enforcement and just-in-time access
- **Security Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Vulnerability and Risk Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-prioritised remediation and risk reporting
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM); device compliance baseline enforcement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design, implement and review security measures across Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments for an 8,000-user organisation, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Entra ID security configuration and M365 Defender suite deployment
- Develop and maintain security architecture artefacts aligned to NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls and ISO 27001, providing a documented security baseline for cloud and hybrid infrastructure
- Oversee the implementation of security engineering best practices and standards including secure configuration baselines, identity governance controls and cloud workload protection policies

- Identify and implement automation opportunities across cloud provisioning, policy enforcement and security operations; develop PowerShell scripts and SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) playbooks that reduce manual effort and improve response consistency
- Own Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) deployment including Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, analytics and threat hunting workflows
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), managing detection policies and investigating advanced threats
- Lead incident response in alignment with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, producing post-incident reports and architecture recommendations to prevent recurrence
- Manage Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, enforcing security baselines across managed devices
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io; produce risk reporting and remediation recommendations for senior leadership

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Implemented and maintained Microsoft Entra ID and Conditional Access policies for identity governance, supporting MFA rollout and SSO integration across Azure-connected and on-premises applications
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as part of the Microsoft 365 Defender suite, improving endpoint and identity threat coverage
- Operated and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, developing Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries and detection analytics to improve signal quality and reduce false positives
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations including user provisioning, alert triage and compliance reporting workflows, improving operational efficiency
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) for device compliance enforcement and application security policy management
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus and tracked remediation to closure through structured reporting
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus governance programmes, producing evidence and documentation for external assessors

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Maintained security controls across a hybrid SaaS/FinTech platform including endpoint security, firewall management, identity access provisioning and vulnerability patching
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance programme including evidence collection, risk register maintenance and audit preparation
- Automated routine security and infrastructure administration tasks using scripting, improving consistency and reducing manual workload
- Managed user access reviews and enforced least-privilege access across cloud and on-premises systems

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive Azure and Microsoft 365 security architecture for an 8,000-user organisation, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Entra ID governance and M365 Defender suite deployment, aligned to CIS Controls and NIST CSF frameworks
- Deployed and integrated CrowdStrike Falcon EDR with Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and SOAR, building automated response playbooks and custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules that significantly reduced mean time to detect and respond
- Delivered Cyber Essentials Plus certification end to end, owning all technical preparation, architecture documentation and assessor engagement from gap assessment to certification
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce just-in-time privileged access, eliminating standing administrative privileges and reducing the lateral movement risk from credential compromise

- Built a PowerShell automation library covering alert processing, user provisioning, log ingestion and compliance reporting, saving an estimated 10+ hours per week and reducing human error in repetitive security engineering tasks
- Reduced vulnerability remediation backlog by 60% through a structured Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io driven programme with risk-prioritised patching cadence

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote/Hybrid (London/UK)